

7. Higher efficiency of the police force

Big data is already proving to be a great boon for the police forces. By assimilating data that can be procured through social media, the police departments are becoming more responsive to threats and emergencies. The matter of monitoring social media data for identifying possibly nefarious activities-controversial though it is, is still something that's practised by security forces. With unprecedented access to personal and social information, it is also hoped that police forces around the world would become better at predicting and preventing crimes before they occur.

These are but the first years of both the manufacturing and government sectors making use of big data, true more for the latter than the former. While it's a fact that meaningful data is more easily available today than ever before, analysing the plethora of data to glean meaning out of it is a skill that still requires a bit of polishing. For the time being at least, such skills are possessed by only a very limited number of individuals in both private and public sectors. And it will only be when the larger population-as both employees and citizens gain a semblance of the skill that all the information out there that goes by the name of big data become a game changer in a huge way. But with the internet becoming a great democratizer of knowledge, such days are not far away or so we can hope.

Meanwhile, governments and companies will continue to benefit from the big data revolution that's underway. 

OBAMA KNOWS PROBLEM SOLVING



Barack Obama announced the Big Data Research and Development Initiative in 2012 spread across 6 departments to analyze how the technology can be deployed to solve problems related to government related issues.